IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 40

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Mercer	
2	violin	
3	left	left ear
4	medium	
5	clear	
6	6	6th, sixth
7	ear drops	
8	stage monitor earpiece	performance earpiece, earpiece
9	two weeks	2 weeks
10	clinic	
11	D	
12	B	
13	H	
14	A	
15	F	
16	C	
17	B	
18	D	
19	A	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	C	
21	B	
22	C	
23	A	
24	B	
25	C	
26	second-year	second year
27	8	eight
28	interruptions	
29	confidence	
30	10	ten
31	water vapour	
32	narrow	
33	ocean	
34	orographic	
35	precipitation	
36	snowpack	
37	location	
38	duration	
39	runoff	
40	range	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Amrita Cole	Good afternoon, this is Northbank Hearing Centre. I will note your musical work and current concern before we choose filters, impressions and collection. I will start with the legal name for your hearing record. What surname should I enter?
Dylan Mercer	The surname is Mercer, M-E-R-C-E-R. My band’s booking uses a stage name, so please use the legal surname here.
Amrita Cole	Tell me about your main instrument and the kind of ensemble in which you usually rehearse.
Dylan Mercer	I play violin in a chamber group, although I occasionally work beside amplified percussion. Most rehearsals are acoustic, but festival work occasionally places me close to amplified percussion.

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Amrita Cole	That pattern helps us choose a filter, alongside sensible distance whenever a particularly loud source is present. You noted uneven fatigue. Which side has been giving you more concern?
Dylan Mercer	The left ear feels more fatigued after rehearsal; the right one has not caused the same problem. Given that most of my work is acoustic, which of the three filter strengths would you recommend?
Amrita Cole	For mainly acoustic work, the medium-strength filter is suitable; the strongest option would remove more detail than you want.
Dylan Mercer	My current foam plugs make speech sound muffled, which is why I sometimes remove one during tuning.
Amrita Cole	A filtered custom pair should preserve more useful detail, but both plugs need to remain in place for balanced protection. The mould colour will not change performance. Which finish would you prefer?
Dylan Mercer	I will choose clear moulds rather than blue, because they are less visible on stage. Will changing the mould colour later alter the filter itself?
Amrita Cole	No, colour is cosmetic; changing attenuation would require a different filter component.
Dylan Mercer	Which date have you booked for the hearing check before the impressions are taken?
Amrita Cole	The hearing check is booked for the sixth of May, with impressions immediately afterwards if the result is suitable.
Dylan Mercer	Is there anything I should avoid putting in my ears on the morning of that appointment?
Amrita Cole	Avoid ear drops on the morning of the appointment unless a clinician has advised them.
Dylan Mercer	Which piece of my stage equipment should I bring so you can check physical compatibility?
Amrita Cole	Bring the stage monitor earpiece so we can check that both devices sit comfortably together.
Dylan Mercer	I will bring my earlier hearing-test details and the earpiece I use during performances.
Amrita Cole	Excellent. We can compare fit and balance with your own equipment during the collection appointment.
Dylan Mercer	How long does your laboratory normally need to complete a pair?
Amrita Cole	Production normally takes two weeks, although a remake would extend that.
Dylan Mercer	When I collect them, where will you check the final seal and left-right balance?
Amrita Cole	The final seal is checked here at the clinic during collection, not remotely at rehearsal.
Dylan Mercer	I have never used custom plugs, so I may need practice inserting them without a mirror.
Amrita Cole	We teach that at collection and mark the cases clearly for the left and right sides.
Dylan Mercer	Can I clean the moulds after every performance without damaging the removable filters?
Amrita Cole	Yes. Take the filters out first, wipe the moulds as demonstrated, and let them dry fully before reassembly. I will confirm the hearing check and impression visit by email as well. Please bring the performance earpiece and your previous test information.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

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Faye Linden	Welcome to Alder Reach ropes course. Follow the woodland plan from check-in through practice, graded loops and the open emergency assembly lawn.
Faye Linden	The check-in lodge is the first building inside the southern gate, before the path reaches the central clearing.
Faye Linden	North is at the top of the plan; graded loops spread from the central practice clearing and return by one shared path.
Faye Linden	Only staff operate rescue equipment, and participants who feel stuck should remain clipped and call to the nearest platform instructor.
Faye Linden	Participants carry no loose cameras; a fixed photography point is available on the ground beside the final route.
Faye Linden	The harness bay is the roofed shelter east of the lodge, connected to it by the short surfaced path.
Faye Linden	Everyone checks in before approaching the harness bay, even if their equipment was fitted on a previous visit.
Faye Linden	The shared return path crosses beneath one route, so ground marshals pause walkers when a supervised rescue is under way.
Faye Linden	The low practice wire is beside the orientation board in the middle of the central clearing, not at the incoming route junction.
Faye Linden	Participants demonstrate the two-clip sequence on a wire close to the ground before entering any coloured route.
Faye Linden	The assembly lawn is deliberately outside the trees and vehicle lane, allowing attendance to be checked during an evacuation.
Faye Linden	The junior loop curves through the western trees and returns beside the rest shelter without crossing the hollow.
Faye Linden	Route colours indicate challenge level, not travel direction, and overtaking on a platform is not allowed.
Faye Linden	Spectators remain on the signed ground trail and must not stand inside landing areas beneath the zip lines.
Faye Linden	The high bridge spans the northern hollow between the two tallest platform groups.
Faye Linden	Loose phones and bags stay in lockers because objects dropped from a platform could injure people below.
Faye Linden	Long hair is tied back and jewellery removed before equipment fitting, while ordinary glasses may be secured with a strap.
Faye Linden	The emergency assembly point is the open lawn east of the return path, outside both the trees and the platform fall zones.
Faye Linden	If wind or lightning closes the course, climbers follow staff instructions to the nearest descent and then assemble on the open lawn.
Faye Linden	A participant who misses a platform instruction waits clipped at the entry point instead of following the person ahead.

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Faye Linden	The blue route is supervised by the platform instructor because it includes two elevated crossings.
Faye Linden	The check-in system records medical information supplied by participants and assigns a coloured wristband for the booked route level.
Faye Linden	Staff check route occupancy by radio so too many climbers do not gather on one sequence of platforms.
Faye Linden	At the upper gate, the route controller authorises each person to enter the red route; the platform instructor supervises only after entry.
Faye Linden	At the harness bay, instructors check waist and leg loops before attaching the continuous safety system.
Faye Linden	The red route closes first in strengthening wind because its exposed upper crossing is the most sensitive section.
Faye Linden	Equipment return is handled at the harness bay after participants leave the final path.
Faye Linden	The practice wire allows people to stop without embarrassment; choosing not to continue does not remove access to the ground trail.
Faye Linden	Water bottles remain at the rest shelter; food is kept away from harnesses and climbing equipment.
Faye Linden	Ground observation is the marshal's responsibility, including people who choose not to climb.
Faye Linden	The junior loop stays low and uses wide platforms, while the blue and red routes add height, movement and longer crossings.
Faye Linden	At session end, instructors inspect returned clips and quarantine any item that was dropped or behaves unusually.
Faye Linden	Before we finish, I will check route bands, equipment understanding and the signal that sends everyone to the assembly lawn.

Part 3 - educational or training discussion

Dr Helen Shaw	For the seminar-layout study, participation must be observable without changing the teaching task. Let us settle the outcome, controls and coding procedure.
Keira Moss	The main outcome should be how speaking turns are distributed across the group, not simply the total number of comments.
Dr Helen Shaw	The project compares room layouts, not the quality of the students' academic opinions.
Keira Moss	The coding manual distinguishes an interruption from supportive overlap, since brief agreement should not automatically count as competitive speech.
Tomislav Reed	Follow-up interviews occur after the second session, when each student can compare two arrangements from direct experience.
Tomislav Reed	If one group has more students, its members have fewer opportunities to speak, so group size must remain constant.
Keira Moss	All groups will discuss the same short case study and receive the same preparation time.

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Tomislav Reed	Microphones remain in identical positions relative to the table centre, and a short test phrase checks audibility before each session.
Dr Helen Shaw	More speech will not automatically mean better discussion; the analysis reports distribution without claiming that quantity proves learning quality.
Dr Helen Shaw	Audio lets us identify speakers and overlaps while avoiding unnecessary images of participants, which makes the procedure less intrusive.
Tomislav Reed	The tutor will use a written opening and closing instruction so one group is not given a warmer introduction.
Dr Helen Shaw	The tutor follows a fixed prompt script and waits the same number of seconds before intervening after silence.
Keira Moss	The facilitator avoids calling on named quiet students, as targeted invitations would change the participation pattern being observed.
Keira Moss	In the pilot, the tutor waited different lengths of time before prompting, so some groups had more opportunity to fill a silence themselves.
Dr Helen Shaw	Speaking time and turn count will be analysed separately because one long contribution should not be treated as many turns.
Keira Moss	If a student is absent, that group session is rescheduled rather than analysed with fewer available speakers.
Tomislav Reed	Transcripts replace every name with a study code before the researchers calculate speaking duration and turn counts.
Tomislav Reed	We will rotate the layouts across seminar groups rather than letting every group encounter the circular arrangement first.
Keira Moss	Participants will choose a study code, allowing the research team to connect both sessions without placing names on transcripts.
Tomislav Reed	Seats are allocated by study code because letting friends cluster could alter turn exchange independently of the furniture arrangement.
Dr Helen Shaw	A rehearsal recording will calibrate the coding rules, but its participants and data will not enter the main comparison.
Dr Helen Shaw	We should recruit second-year students, whose seminar experience is established but still broadly comparable.
Dr Helen Shaw	Two coders will independently score a sample of recordings, then discuss definitions where their classifications differ.
Keira Moss	Eight students per group will allow several voices without making reliable speaker identification unmanageable.
Dr Helen Shaw	The three layouts will be a circle, a U shape and paired rectangular tables, each assembled from the same movable furniture.
Keira Moss	Room bookings use the same teaching space and matched afternoon slots to limit variation in acoustics, fatigue and corridor noise.
Tomislav Reed	Observers will record interruptions separately from supportive overlaps, because the two may affect participation differently.

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Keira Moss	Students receive one case text forty-eight hours before class, so unfamiliar reading cannot explain a quieter contribution in one condition.
Tomislav Reed	The observer notes a fire alarm, late arrival or unexpected room entry, because these events may interrupt only one condition.
Dr Helen Shaw	Before the first seminar, a brief scale will record speaking confidence so we can check whether one layout begins with a more confident group.
Tomislav Reed	Keira will prepare the confidence scale, I will test the turn-coding sheet, and Dr Shaw will approve the rotated timetable.
Tomislav Reed	Numbered place cards let observers identify voices from the audio without attaching names to the coding spreadsheet.
Dr Helen Shaw	Participation is voluntary, contributes nothing to grades and can be withdrawn before the anonymised data are combined.
Keira Moss	The follow-up interview will last ten minutes and ask what made it easier or harder to enter the discussion.
Dr Helen Shaw	A speaking turn begins when a student takes the floor and ends after a meaningful pause or another speaker gains it.
Keira Moss	The confidence scale is completed before students see the first layout, preventing the furniture itself from shaping the baseline response.
Tomislav Reed	The seminar study now separates layout, speaker confidence and tutor behaviour while keeping the discussion task consistent across groups.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Professor Evan Marr	Today I will use a coastal-forecasting simulation from our methods course. Its storm track and impact figures belong to the exercise, so focus on how the forecast develops.
Professor Evan Marr	For the exercise, we use atmospheric river for a narrow zone carrying concentrated water vapour, not liquid water in the sky.
Professor Evan Marr	Our satellite, radar and aircraft records sample different parts of the corridor, comparing offshore shape, inland precipitation and changing intensity.
Professor Evan Marr	In the forecast notes, integrated vapour transport combines wind and moisture through a vertical slice, making it more informative than surface humidity alone.
Professor Evan Marr	Relative to its length, the corridor is narrow, although its boundaries shift through time.
Professor Evan Marr	In these notes, the term covers atmospheric transport over thousands of kilometres, even though the corridor remains comparatively narrow.
Professor Evan Marr	Moisture is carried by strong winds through a deep layer, with supply and loss changing as the system travels.
Professor Evan Marr	For our forecast scenario, imagine the corridor weakening offshore, then intensifying again near the coast.
Professor Evan Marr	Communicators can describe confidence in broad timing while remaining less certain about the narrow band of heaviest rain.

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Professor Evan Marr	Much of the moisture comes from evaporation over the ocean and may be supplemented along the route.
Professor Evan Marr	In the simulation's next stage, landfall is not automatically damaging; the region may depend on the event for water supply.
Professor Evan Marr	Follow a four-step forecast chain: oceanic moisture, atmospheric transport, terrain and local exposure.
Professor Evan Marr	On the worksheet, rising terrain causes orographic uplift as the air moves inland.
Professor Evan Marr	Impacts vary with antecedent soil moisture, freezing level, terrain and the timing of other storms.
Professor Evan Marr	The model shelters the leeward side of its mountains, contrasting its two regions.
Professor Evan Marr	Cooling promotes condensation and can produce intense precipitation on windward slopes.
Professor Evan Marr	Moist air rises over hills and mountains, forming condensation, clouds and precipitation on the windward side.
Professor Evan Marr	The same precipitation becomes hazardous when catchments are saturated or freezing levels rise over deep existing snow.
Professor Evan Marr	In the track test, shifting the forecast corridor moves the heaviest rainfall from one named basin to another.
Professor Evan Marr	The next sequence sends several atmospheric rivers through the study area, increasing cumulative rain and snow totals.
Professor Evan Marr	We now turn to the forecast record: sparse offshore observations combine with model guidance, leaving uncertainty before landfall.
Professor Evan Marr	In cold conditions, the event may add substantially to the snowpack rather than falling entirely as rain.
Professor Evan Marr	River response occurs after atmospheric forcing, and the lag differs with basin size, slope and existing water content.
Professor Evan Marr	In the forecast case, the exact landfall location determines which labelled catchment receives the heaviest precipitation.
Professor Evan Marr	Forecast models differ in track and timing, and those differences propagate into river forecasts and reservoir decisions.
Professor Evan Marr	Reservoir operators balance flood space against water supply, using updated forecasts rather than one decision made at the start of the storm.
Professor Evan Marr	For the reservoir plan, revisit the water-management decision whenever the observations or guidance are updated.
Professor Evan Marr	The worksheet asks students to estimate the event's duration as well as its peak strength before comparing outcomes.
Professor Evan Marr	For this lecture, my recommendation is to state both the most likely forecast and a credible alternative, so listeners can see what remains uncertain.

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Professor Evan Marr	Time-integrated vapour transport helps forecasters describe moisture delivered over a period, not only a single peak.
Professor Evan Marr	The final block compares impacts across the study area. Its agricultural zone may gain soil moisture while transport and urban drainage face disruption.
Professor Evan Marr	Recently burned slopes may produce rapid runoff because vegetation and soil structure have been altered.
Professor Evan Marr	Warm events can raise the snowline and add rain to existing snow, increasing runoff more quickly than a colder event.
Professor Evan Marr	On the worksheet, vapour transport is the horizontal flow of water vapour through the model atmosphere.
Professor Evan Marr	A landfalling event may be beneficial when reservoirs are low and soils can absorb rain without producing damaging runoff.
Professor Evan Marr	Burn scars and urban surfaces can produce rapid runoff, whereas forested or dry soils may respond more slowly.
Professor Evan Marr	For the planning task, compare three plausible tracks and rainfall totals before choosing a response for the training town.
Professor Evan Marr	Freezing level is crucial because rain falling onto snow has different runoff consequences from new snow stored at altitude.
Professor Evan Marr	In the debrief, each group explains how its chosen threshold altered the response; the aim is to compare decisions, not declare a universal threshold.
Professor Evan Marr	For the public bulletin, communicate an uncertainty range instead of presenting one track and rainfall total as certain.
Professor Evan Marr	To close the simulation, the corridor gains moisture from the ocean, mixes with surrounding air and loses water through precipitation.
Professor Evan Marr	After the event, the class compares the forecast with the course observations to locate errors in transport, landfall or terrain response.
Professor Evan Marr	Ensemble forecasts sample multiple plausible developments, producing a distribution rather than one supposedly exact future path.
Professor Evan Marr	My final recommendation is to update track, duration and uncertainty whenever new observations alter the range of local impacts.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	C	
2	F	
3	B	
4	E	
5	A	
6	D	
7	clay	
8	socket	
9	salt	
10	ringing sound	
11	plain end	
12	root intrusion	
13	diameter	
14	v	
15	i	
16	iii	
17	vii	
18	iv	
19	FALSE	
20	TRUE	
21	TRUE	
22	FALSE	
23	NOT GIVEN	
24	seed particles	
25	dried	
26	contaminants	
27	YES	
28	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	NO	
30	YES	
31	NOT GIVEN	
32	H	
33	C	
34	F	
35	B	
36	I	
37	G	
38	B	
39	D	
40	C	

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